



CRAVE IT | CRUNCH IT | COOK IT

Habit Engineering: Closing the ₹1170Cr Habit Ownership Gap for Wai Wai

Wai Wai Is Considered But Never Chosen: The ₹1170Cr Annual Habit Ownership Gap

THE 11PM TRIGGER

- A student opens Blinkit at 11:15 PM, types "noodles," and taps the first result without reading the label.
- Wai Wai is on the same screen at the same price, unselected.

This is not an awareness problem; it is a default-bias problem.

KEY METRICS

30%

First-choice rate (avg: 100%)

2.1×

Purchases/month vs 3.4× avg (comp)

56%

Cart abandonment (Blinkit)

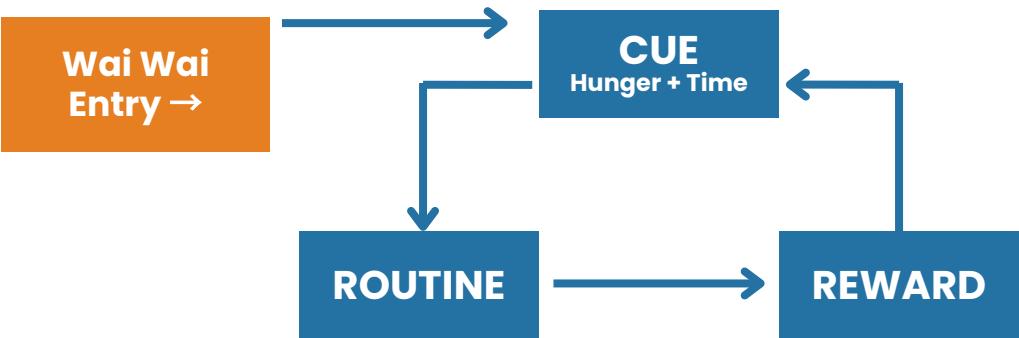
28–30%

National share; <10% South/West

BEHAVIORAL ROOT CAUSE



Competitor brands have colonised the cue-routine-reward cycle through 30+ years of conditioning. Breaking this requires inserting Wai Wai at the **cue stage**, not through advertising recall.



THE OPPORTUNITY

1.3 missed purchases/month × 50M consumers × ₹15 ASP x 12 months = **₹1170 Cr annual unrealised revenue** from the frequency gap alone. Solving habit ownership is the single highest-leverage strategic move available.

~₹1170Cr

Annual unrealised revenue from the habit ownership gap

Wai Wai's challenge is not brand building; it is habit engineering. The brand that owns the cue, owns the category.

A ₹12,000Cr Category of Automatic Behavior: Five Barriers Keeping Wai Wai Out

COMPETITIVE POSITIONING



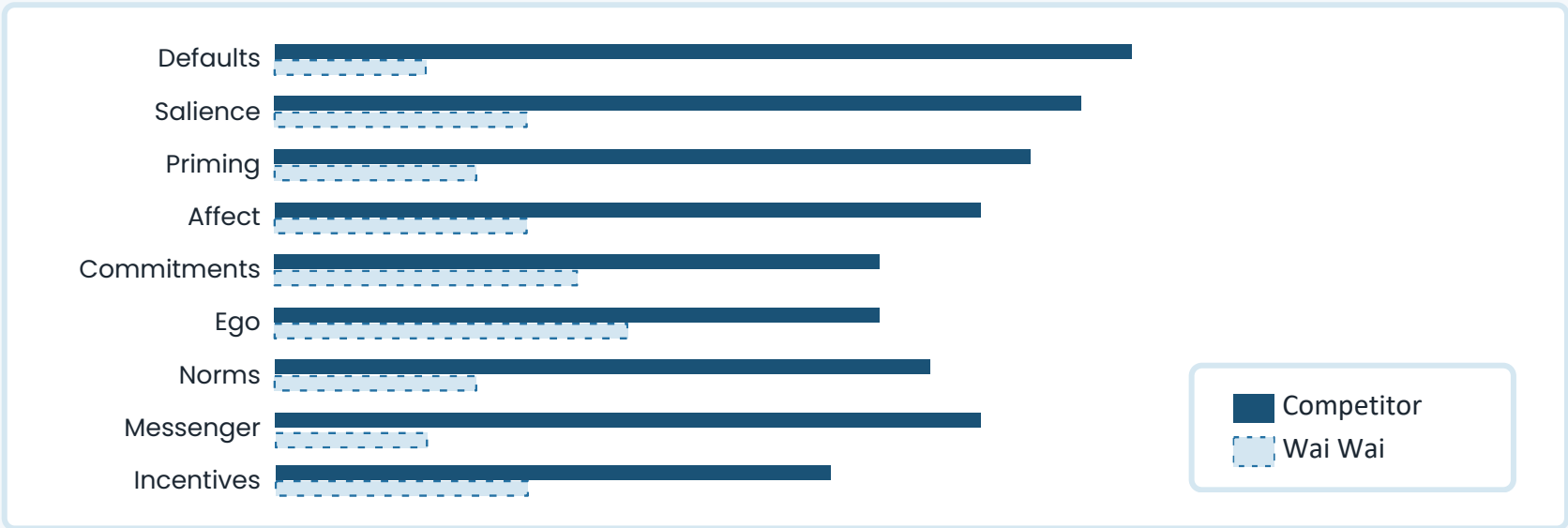
THE FIVE BEHAVIORAL BARRIERS

Barrier	Behavioral Driver	Business Impact
1. Habit Monopoly	Default bias; competitor owns cue-routine-reward loop	First choice only 30%
2. Intention–Action Gap	Decision friction + loss aversion at checkout	56% cart abandonment
3. Regional Deficit	Availability heuristic failure; zero social proof	Very low share S/W India
4. Health Perception	Framing: "instant noodle = junk" schema	Suppressed urban freq.
5. Platform Architecture	Quick commerce apps favour category leader	Visible but not salient

WAI WAI'S UNIQUE PROPOSITION (UNDERACTIVATED)

The only instant noodle **consumable both cooked and raw**, competing in the **₹12,000Cr noodle** AND **₹1,16,000Cr branded snack** markets simultaneously.

MINDSPACE ACTIVATION GAP VS. CATEGORY LEADER



Wai Wai's dual use proposition is the most powerful untapped behavioral lever in the category and no competitor can replicate it.

Three Behavioral Profiles, Three Distinct Points of Failure Along the Journey

HABITUAL LOYALIST (ROHAN)

Auto pilot buyer. Defaults to the category leader .
Never evaluates alternatives.

Active Biases: Default Bias & Anchoring (The competitor set original taste reference, so his brain defaults to it to save energy).

EKB Dropout: Internal Search: The hunger cue auto retrieves Maggi; Wai Wai never enters consideration while ordering.

Fogg Gap: Motivation · Ability · Prompt
M and A are high. Behavior fails purely due to an absent Prompt.

Priority: Cue hijacking at trigger moment.
Replace the cue, not the product.

Habit Rewiring

Cue Engineering

EXPERIMENTAL SNACKER (ANANYA)

Browses late night, adds to cart, drops off. High intent, low follow through.

Core Bias: Intention–Action Gap (High intent to try, but abandons cart due to friction)

EKB Dropout: Purchase Decision:
Friction at checkout and absent social validation.

Fogg Gap: Motivation · Ability · Prompt
Motivation is high, but Ability drops at checkout due to cognitive friction

Priority: Friction reduction and social proof at checkout.
Address loss aversion.

Choice Architecture

Social Proof

EMERGING ADOPTER (KAVYA)

South/West India. Risk averse. No taste memory or peer validation for Wai Wai.

Core Bias: Availability Heuristic (She has no memory or social proof of Wai Wai).

EKB Dropout: External Search and Evaluation
No salient info; competitor defaults to top.

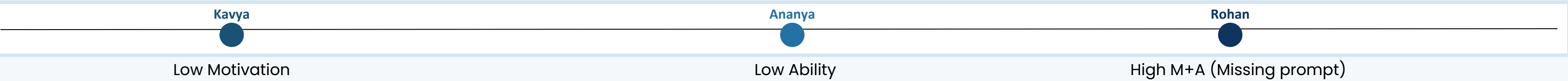
COM–B: Zero Social Opportunity completely suppresses her Reflective Motivation to try.

Priority: Trial facilitation first.
Social proof and habit formation second.

Trial Nudge

EAST Framework

FOGG MAP GRID (THREE PERSONAS PLOTTED)



A single marketing campaign cannot solve three different psychological barriers. Our strategy must replace the Cue for Rohan, eliminate the Risk for Ananya, and engineer Familiarity for Kavya.

EKB and Fogg Reveal: Wai Wai Loses at Internal Search and Prompt, Not at Awareness

EKB CONSUMER JOURNEY - WHERE WAI WAI EXITS

EKB Stage	Consumer Action	Wai Wai	Root Barrier
1. Problem Recognition	Hunger triggers need	Present	None, awareness exists
2. Internal Search	Brain retrieves brand	Exits	Competitor habit loop entirely bypasses alternative evaluation.
3. External Search	Opens Blinkit, searches	Exits	Platform defaults favour leader
4. Evaluation	Compares visible options	No diff.	"Eat raw" USP not prominent
5. Purchase Decision	Commits to cart	56% drop	Friction triggers the intention-action gap.
6. Post Purchase	Eats; reinforces habit	No loop	No reward mechanism

68% typed "noodles" and selected the first result without scrolling. Wai Wai rarely appears in top 3.

DIAGNOSIS → PRESCRIPTION: INTERVENTION MAP

Failing Stage	Root Cause	Intervention	Project
2. Internal Search	Automatic Motivation defaults to competitor.	Cue engineering at 11 PM trigger	CRAVE
3. External Search	Platform defaults suppress Wai Wai	Choice architecture, "Night Snack" shelf	CONVERT
4. Evaluation	Dual, use USP invisible	Packaging, "Cook It or Crunch It"	CRAVE
5. Purchase Decision	Intention-Action gap caused by choice overload.	Social proof & default 3 pack bundle	CONVERT
6. Post Purchase	No reward mechanism	Wai Wai Streak + #CrunchItChallenge	CRAVE

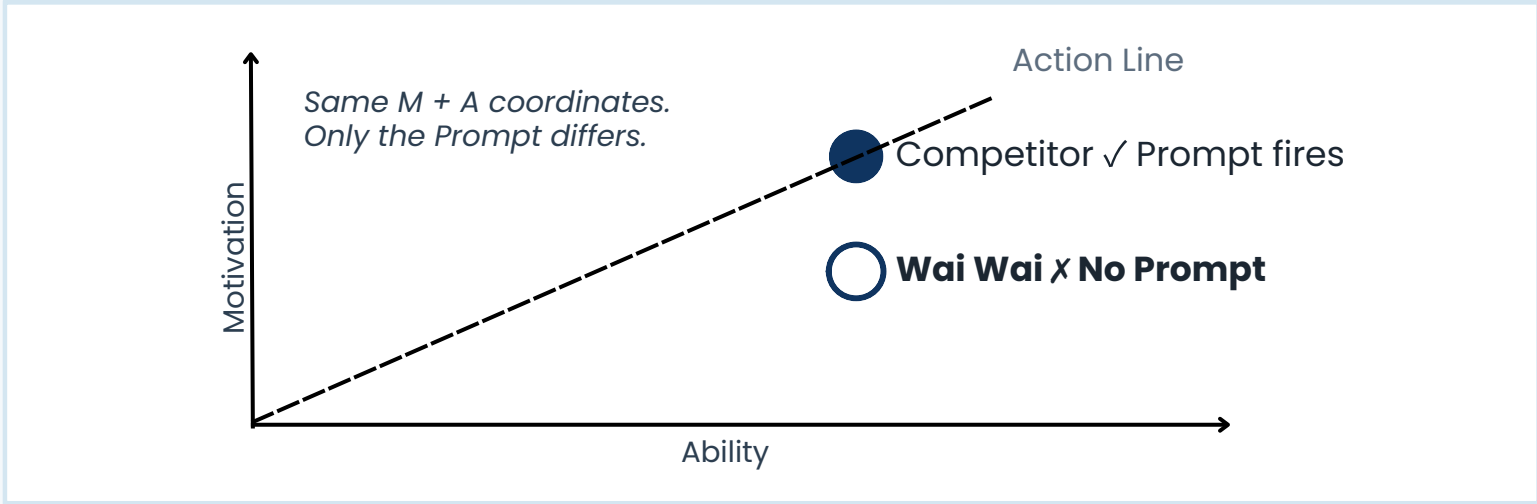
COM-B DIAGNOSIS

Component	Status	Intervention
Capability	Present	Maintain, not the bottleneck
Opportunity	Absent	Architect platform defaults (Physical) & engineer peer proof (Social).
Motivation (Auto)	Absent	Engineer external sparks to hijack existing Automatic Motivation loops.

FOGG BEHAVIOR MODEL: B = M × A × P

Component	Current State	Gap
Motivation (M)	Moderate, hunger present	No emotional anchor vs competitor
Ability (A)	High, affordable, easy prep	Minimal. Not the problem.
Prompt (P)	Absent at trigger moments	Missing external 'Spark' prompt to interrupt the competitor's trigger.

ACTION LINE: PROMPT IS THE ONLY GAP



Wai Wai loses at Stage 2 (Internal Search) and Stage 5 (Purchase Decision). Both trace to one root cause: the Prompt is absent.

Project CRAVE: Engineer the Cue-Routine-Reward Loop for Automatic Choice

INITIATIVE 1 - CUE ENGINEERING

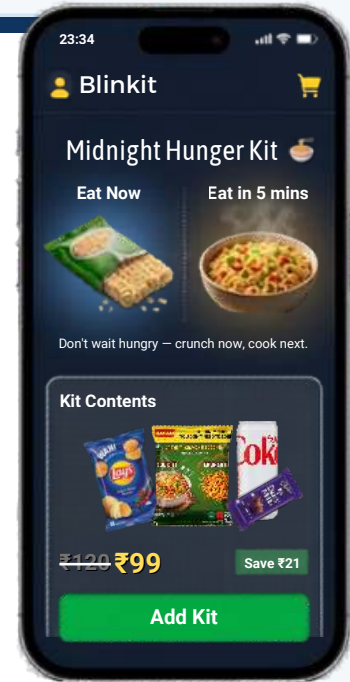
Fogg Prompt at peak motivation moments

- **Discounted “Midnight Snack Kit”** on QC platforms
- Time-triggered push at 11:45 PM: *“It’s 12 AM. Crunch time? Wai Wai in 10 mins.”*
- **“Quick Snack / Study Fuel”**: Wai Wai anchors this slot instead of competing in “Noodles”
- **The ‘Wait & Snack’ Nudge**: Cross-sell pop-up on competitor noodles (“Snack on raw Wai Wai while Maggi cooks!”)

STARBUCKS “AFTERNOON MADE” (2019)
Time-specific 3 PM push: 34% uplift in afternoon visits, 23% revenue increase.

SWIGGY INSTAMART DEFAULTS
Top-position brands achieve **3.4× higher conversion**. Category ownership = **60% repeat** uplift.

Timely · Easy · Priming · Salience



INITIATIVE 2 - PACKAGING AS CUE

MINDSPACE: Salience & Priming. Detail on Slide 6.

- **New pack** communicates **“Crunch It or Cook It”** dual-use visual creating a novel schema
- Pack becomes the cue: **“eat raw”** instruction on front panel triggers novel behaviour
- **QR code & “50 Raw Recipes”**: converts first raw consumption into habit formation
- **Nutrition badge**: “0 Trans Fat | Real Spices | No Added MSG”
- **Additional** Portion Size – 1.5x Original (Cook 1 while you munch on 0.5)

MAGGI PACKAGING REFRESH (2022)
Ingredient transparency: 18% increase in purchase intent among urban 18–35 year old.

BRITANNIA NUTRICHoice REBRAND
Health badge + visual language: 31% Year 1 growth. No formula change.

Attractive · Salience · Priming · Affect

INITIATIVE 3 - REWARD LOOP & NORMS

Variable reward & peer driven habit reinforcement

- **Wai Wai Streak**: On 3 consecutive purchases get Variable Partner company coupons
- Deploy 50 micro-KOLs (₹15L) to trigger the social media challenge: **#CrunchItChallenge**, making “The CRUNCH” viral.
- **Campus Takeovers**: 10 canteen **tie-ups** + Red Bull-style **student ambassadors** driving the “raw Wai Wai & chai” habit.
- **Hackathon Fuel**: Sponsor **all-night tech events** to cement raw Wai Wai as the definitive 3 AM study snack.

DUOLINGO STREAK MECHANIC
Variable reward: 34% DAU increase. Loss aversion > positive motivation.

HALDIRAM'S UGC SOUTH INDIA
180K+ User Generated Content posts, 40% top of mind recall increase in 12 months.

Social · Attractive · Norms · Ego · Commitments

Project CRAVE targets all three Fogg components: Motivation (reward loop), Ability (frictionless cue), Prompt (time triggered + contextual). When all three align, behaviour becomes automatic.

New Packaging Transforms "Crunch It or Cook It" into a Permanent, Free Behavioural Cue

CURRENT PACKAGING-DIAGNOSIS

CURRENT WAI WAI PACK

- Generic bowl of noodles (visual identical to competitors like maggi).
- No raw consumption mention on front face (misses novelty). No health badge.
- Cluttered, fails the 2-second shelf attention test.



PROPOSED NEW PACKAGING-DESIGN SPEC

NEW WAI WAI PACK DESIGN

- LEFT "COOK IT" | RIGHT "CRUNCH IT".
- "The only noodle you don't need to cook."
- Badges: "Real Spices | Chef approved spices" + QR → 50 Recipes.



SCIENCE BEHIND REDESIGN

Design Element	Current Problem	Behavioral Effect
Front panel hero	Cooked bowl: identical to competitors	Brain: "same as Maggi"
USP communication	"Eat raw" not on front	Core differentiator invisible
Health signals	None prominent	Defaults to "junk" schema

Decision	Mechanism	Expected Outcome
Dual-zone (Cook/Crunch)	Salience: novel stimulus; Priming: snack category	Differentiated in 2-sec shelf scan
COOK IT CRUNCH IT headline	Framing Effect: versatile	Trial conversion rises
Health badge prominent	Availability Heuristic: visible info is used	Reduces urban freq. suppression
QR – Raw Recipes	Commitment Device: scanning initiates behaviour	Post purchase habit rise

LAY'S REFRESH (2019) + HALDIRAM'S (2020): Ingredient transparency: **12% market share gain**. Packaging modernisation: **23% premium volume growth**. Both: zero formula change.

Packaging is the cheapest media channel. The new design converts every pack shipped from a commodity wrapper into an active behavioural prompt for dual-use consumption.

Project CONVERT: Choice Architecture to Close the 56% Intention–Action Gap

INITIATIVE 1 – PLATFORM CHOICE ARCHITECTURE

Target: Blinkit cart abandonment 56% → 36%

- **Default to 3-pack bundle pre-selected**
(72% accept pre-selected options)
- **Real-time social proof:** "1,200+ packs sold in Delhi today".
- **Contextual scarcity during promotions:**
"Limited stock at this price"
- **Smart bundle:** "Wai Wai Raw + [partner company that goes well] for tonight".

BOOKMYSHOW SCARCITY (2019)
"Only 3 seats left" → 27% drop in abandonment. "1,200 viewing" → 23% uplift.

AMAZON SUBSCRIBE & SAVE
Default subscription → 40% higher LTV. "Frequently Bought" → 35% cart uplift.

Defaults · Norms · Incentives

INITIATIVE 2 – MARKETING REALLOCATION

Current CAC: ₹60–80 via broad spend → micro-targeting

- **Retarget cart abandoners:**
10% → 35% (6× conversion vs cold)
- **Time-triggered 10 PM–12 AM:**
15% → 30% (Fogg Prompt at peak)
- **Regional entry (S/W):**
20% → 25% (familiarity building)
- **Broad awareness:**
55% → 10% (low behavioral ROI)

CAC COMPARISON
Current marketing: ₹65.
Social proof badge: ₹4.
Time-triggered retarget: ₹12.

Salience · Priming · Timely

INITIATIVE 3 – REGIONAL EXPANSION VIA EAST

South/West India: build familiarity before habit

- ₹5 first-purchase cashback via PhonePe/GPay.
Pre-stocked kirana displays
- **Regional flavors:** South Masala (tamarind + curry leaf), Coconut Masala (Kerala)
- **Social:** "Most ordered in [locality]" badge.
20 micro-KOLs/city. University canteens
- **Festival tie-ins:** Pongal, Onam, Navratri geo-targeted campaigns

HALDIRAM'S SOUTH INDIA (2017-20)
Local flavor + kirana-first: 18% share in AP/TN in 3 years.

PARLE-G RURAL – SHG NETWORK
40% rural penetration in 2 years at near-zero CAC.

Easy · Attractive · Social · Timely · Norms

Project CONVERT addresses all three EKB failures, platform visibility, differentiation, and checkout friction, through architecture, not advertising spend.

Three-Phase Deployment: Test Behavioral Nudges, Engineer the Habit, Scale Regionally

IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

	Phase 1 - Test				Phase 2 - Engineer				Phase 3 - Scale			
Initiative	A1	A2	A3	A4	A5	A6	A7	A8	A9	A10	A11	A12
Platform choice architecture												
Performance marketing realloc.												
Time-triggered push system												
Packaging rebrand - pilot												
#CrunchItChallenge + KOLs												
Wai Wai Streak loyalty												
S/W India kirana distribution												
Regional flavor variants												
National packaging rollout												

Active

Monitoring

Key: A = 1.5 months

PHASE 1 - TEST (MONTHS 1-6)

Deploy platform nudges on **Blinkit** in 2 metro cities. A/B test control vs nudge-enhanced listing. **Reallocate** performance marketing; launch push notification pilot.
KPI gate: cart completion 44% → 52%

PHASE 2 - ENGINEER (MONTHS 7-12)

Packaging rebrand launch in pilot cities. **#CrunchItChallenge** UGC campaign. Wai Wai Streak loyalty activation. All three Fogg components operating.
KPI gate: purchase freq. 2.1 → 2.6×

PHASE 3 - SCALE (MONTHS 13-18)

South/West India kirana distribution + **regional flavors**. National **packaging rollout**. Carry forward all nudge infrastructure.
KPI gate: S/W share <10% → 20% within 18 months

Phase sequencing follows COM-B logic: fix Opportunity first (platform), then Motivation (habit loop & packaging), then scale Capability (regional). Each phase funds the next.

Behavioural Interventions Projected to Unlock ₹934Cr at ~12.4× ROI

KPI DASHBOARD - CURRENT VS. TARGETS

KPI	Now	12M	18M	If Not Met
Purchase freq. (mo)	2.1×	2.6×	3.0×	Add morning trigger
Cart conversion	44%	58%	66%	A/B test alt. copy
First-choice rate	30%	42%	52%	Increase platform default
S/W share	<10%	16%	24%	Accelerate regional flavors
Trial → repeat	~35%	50%	64%	Strengthen Streak rewards
Packaging ASP	₹15	₹17	₹17	Test ₹17 urban MT

INVESTMENT BREAKDOWN

Initiative	One-Time	Ongoing per yr	Payback
Platform nudge infra	₹8-10Cr	₹2Cr	<2 mo
Packaging redesign	₹15Cr	₹3Cr	3 mo
Streak loyalty backend	₹5Cr	₹4Cr	4 mo
Micro-KOL + UGC	₹2Cr	₹1.5Cr	1 mo
Regional distribution	₹10Cr	₹5Cr	6 mo
Regional flavor R&D	₹8Cr	₹2Cr	8 mo

REVENUE IMPACT MODEL

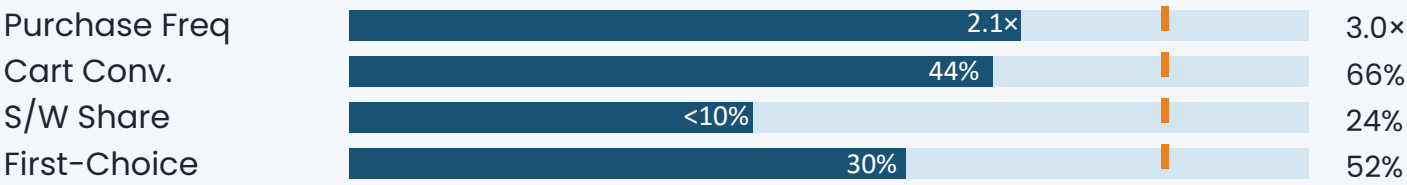
Lever	Assumption	Annual Incr.
Freq: 2.1 → 2.8×	50M × 0.7 × ₹15	₹630Cr
Cart: 56% → 38%	0.81Cr inc. pack/mo × ₹15 × 12 mo.	₹145Cr
Regional: <10% → 22%	₹700Cr mkt × 12pp	₹84Cr
Packaging ASP +₹2	37.8Cr packs (30% vol) × ₹2 premium	₹75Cr
Total Incremental		₹934Cr
Investment	Full 18-month rollout cost	₹75Cr
Estimated ROI		~12.4× over 18mo

RISK & MITIGATION MATRIX

Risk	P	S	Mitigation
Platform resistance	M	H	Revenue-share: 0.5% recovered cart revenue
Packaging dilutes NE brand	L	M	A/B test 2 cities first; retain wordmark
Regional cannibalises core	L	L	Separate SKU, +₹2 premium, 3mo pilot
#CrunchIt negative UGC	L	M	Moderate before featuring; KOL-seeded

P- Probability, S - Sensitivity

NORTH STAR: 18-MONTH TARGET



Wai Wai doesn't need more awareness, it needs to become automatic. The brand that owns the cue owns the category. At ₹75Cr for ₹934Cr return, this is the most capital-efficient growth lever.